

Content templates

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What are content templates?

Models that outline the structure and messaging of frequently-occurring content scenarios

Error messages

Error messages notify a customer when something has gone wrong.

Title

- Right off the bat, state the error. The customer first and foremost wants to know why the flow they're in has been disrupted.
- Be precise if you know why the error occurred, but don't get too into the technical weeds. Consider the customer's mental model of how the given system works.

Subtitle

- If applicable, focus on resolution. Explain what Verizon is doing on their end to move things forward or suggest how the customer might be able to progress.

Button(s) or Text Link(s)

- If applicable, link to the remedial action a customer can take or a page with more information.

Confirmation dialogs

Confirmation dialogs are messages that interrupt a customer to verify if they are sure they want to proceed with an action. They're triggered when a customer issues a command to the system.

1. Title

- Frame as a question and preface with "Are you sure you want to _?"

2. Subtitle

- Clarify what would be lost.
- Be specific in a way that supports decision-making.

3. Proceed button

- Restate the verb from the original command followed by the object of the command when space allows.
- For example, if a customer initiates a command by selecting a CTA that says "Cancel trade-in," the affirmative CTA in the confirmation dialog should use the verb "Cancel" and the object "trade-in."

4. Don't proceed button

- Begin CTA with "Don't" followed by the verb from the original command.
- For example, "Don't cancel"

New section in content guidelines include:

1

Are you sure you want to [command] [object]?

2

[Additional context]

3

[Command] [object]

4

Don't [command]

Templates

Guidance on what info to put where and how to organize it for the best experience.

Error messages notify a customer when something is wrong.

General principles:

- Be as specific as you can.
- Don't blame the customer.
- Provide a path to resolution.
- Don't prepend the error message with an
- If the error came from Verizon's end, it's our fault — or better yet, thank the customer for their patience.

Guidelines

Tips on how to be clear and helpful.

Type of error	Variant	Fragments (choose the copy fragments that best suit the context)	
		Title fragments (statement of error)	Subtitle fragments (resolution, if applicable)
Backend error			
	Connection error/system can't execute function	- Something went wrong. - We're having trouble [action user was trying to take].	- Rest assured, we're working on getting things fixed as soon as we can. - Please try again later. Thanks for your patience. - [Provide additional context if available.]
Account regulation error			
Customer reached a limitation	Capacity reached	- You've reached [describe limit]. - [Clear and succinct way of communicating user has hit capacity, e.g. Your storage is full]	- [If necessary, provide additional context and/or offer a resolution.]
	Subscription expired	- [Name of subscription] has expired.	- [If necessary, provide additional context and/or focus on resolution.]
	Permissions error	- You must be an account [role] to [action user was trying to take].	- Find out who your account [role] is by visiting your account settings.

Ready-made messages

Pre-written text to plug when writing for a generic error.

They support teams' output & processes

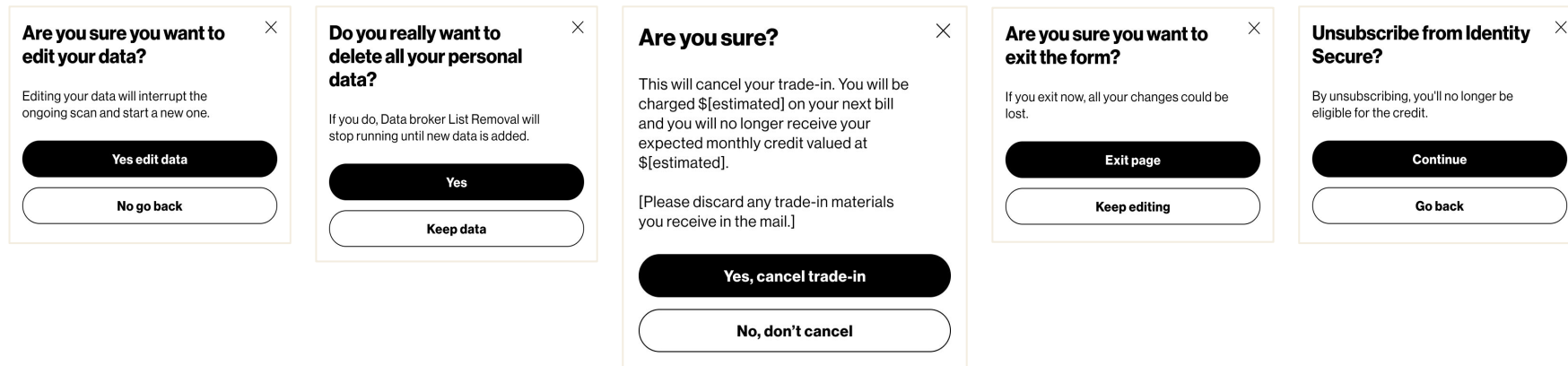
Drive cohesion

Enable efficiency

Ensure quality

The same scenario can appear very differently across an experience

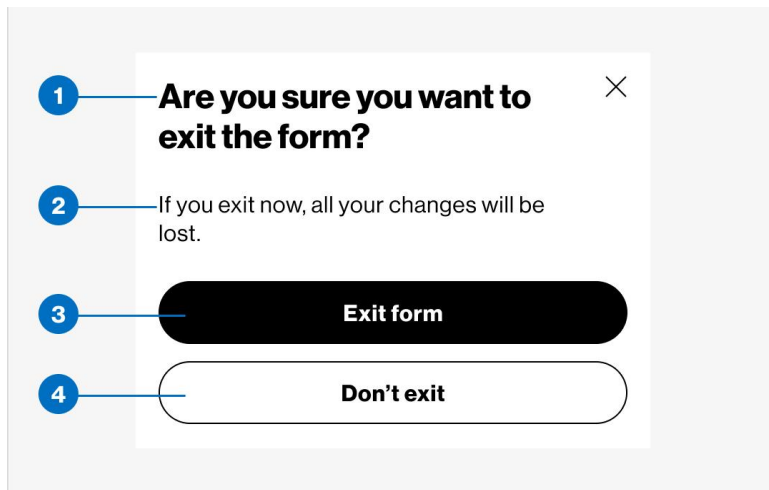
Confirmation dialogs had varied phrasing, mixed tones and different language patterns.



With templates

Content throughout an experience sounds like it's from the same source

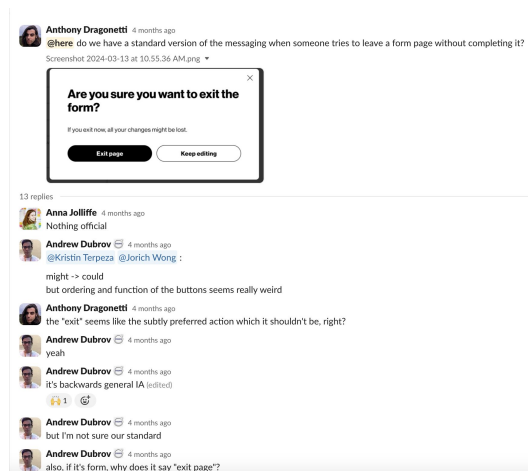
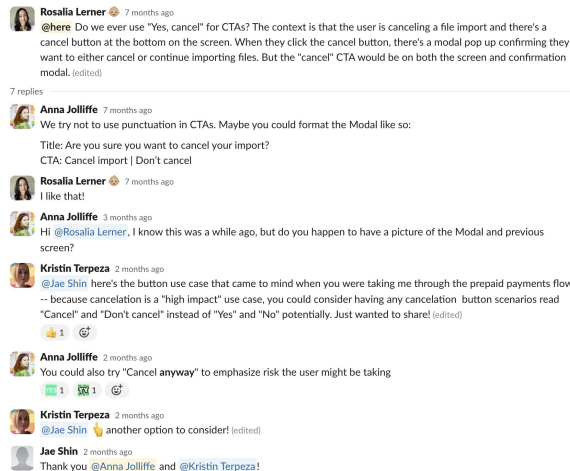
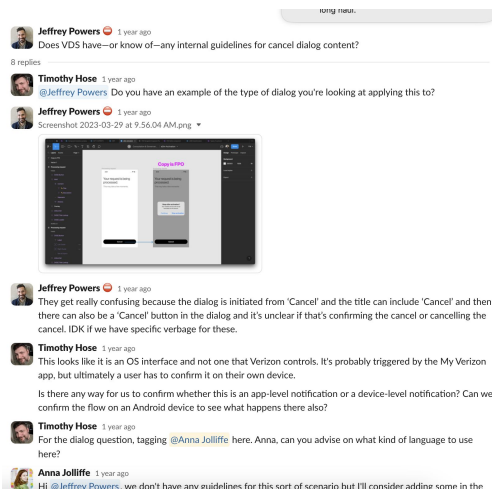
Confirmation dialogs now have a standard way of being phrased that's human and supportive according to user tests.



Without templates

Designers and Content Strategists are reinventing the wheel each time

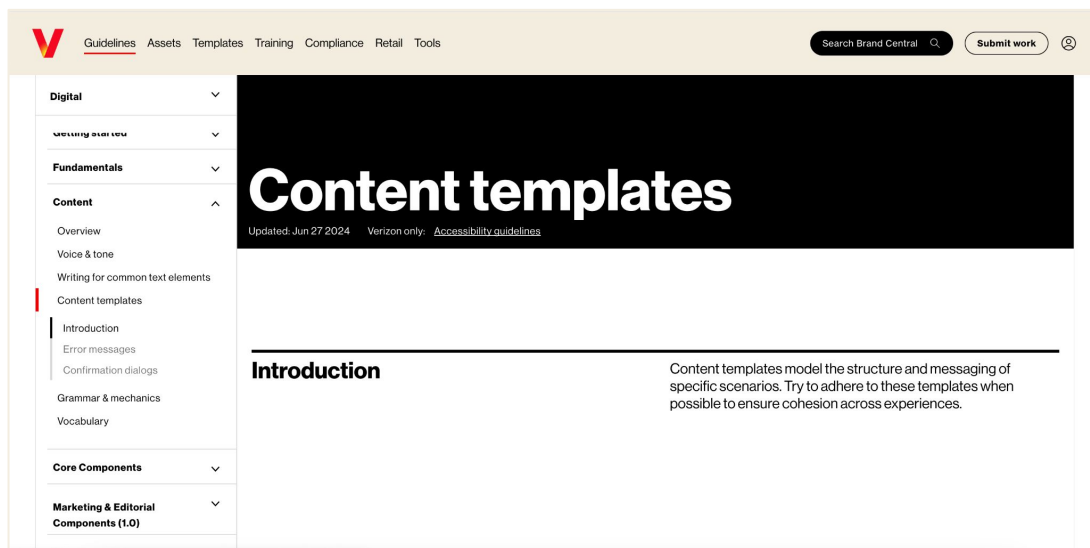
Team members waste time and effort hunting down the last time they or someone else wrote something similar.



With templates

Teams can draw from the established standard

Templates are easily located in VDS on Brand Central.



Self-service can result in compromised quality

Without Content Strategy resources, clarity and supportiveness of content might be impaired. Voice and tone is also at risk of missing the mark.

⚠ Looks like there was a problem with the payment information you provided. Please select a new payment method in order to continue.

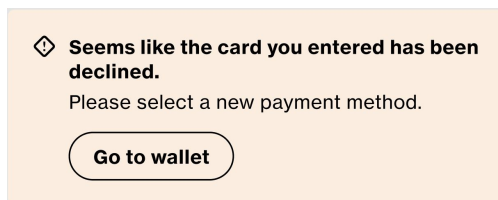
Holding all information in the title without any hierarchy impairs scannability.

You must be signed in as an Account Owner to access this page.

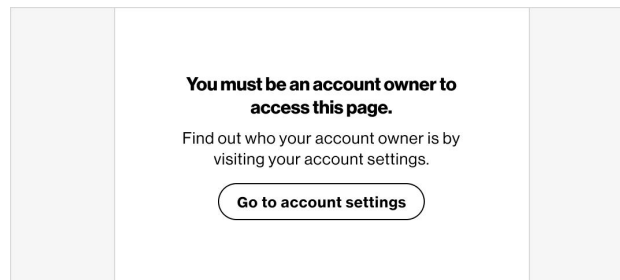
Customer is left on their own to figure out who their account owner is.

Templates ensure that a minimum standard of quality is met

Templates are developed following a rigorous discovery and development process. The result is an asset that enables all team members, regardless of their discipline, to self-serve.



Error templates like this elevate critical information in a title and nest secondary information in a subtitle.



Including a path to a likely next step improves the actionability of an error message.

Feel free to reach out

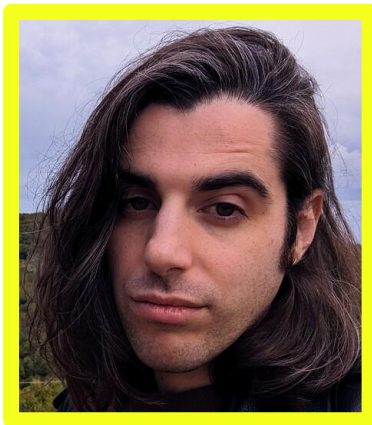
Our team is actively working to develop more content templates.

Please reach out to any of us with:

- Feedback on existing templates
- Candidates for new templates



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Anna Jolliffe

